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16 August 2026

Dr. Chun-Wei Yang
Handling Editor
Scientific Reports

Dear Dr. Yang,

Please find the major revision of *RankCloak: Hiding Synthetic Cryptographic Artifacts in Plain English with Language Models* (submission 0170c7b2-1065-4344-a5d5-b839b51ac22c). We thank you and the reviewers for the detailed guidance. The manuscript replaces the original partial-pilot evidence with the completed, manifest-bound study and is accompanied by a point-by-point response.

The revision expands the corpus to 480 public deterministic outputs from eight declared cryptographic classes, evaluated across three open-source model families and 18 English prompt templates in six categories. It adds grouped inference, controlled transmission perturbations and first-divergence analysis, automated readability and held-out quality diagnostics, filter/lead-in/segment/tail ablations, prompt-topic contrasts, formal capacity relationships, secondary Spanish and Simplified Chinese exact-copy recovery, and computational-overhead measurements.

We also added a 15,840-row neural-steganalysis study using TextCNN-equivalent and DeBERTa-v3-base classifiers across matched and held-out regimes, with leakage and near-duplicate sensitivity audits. Matched ROC-AUC was near one for both architectures and is presented as adverse evidence. The revised conclusions do not claim undetectability, secure or robust communication, or deployment readiness.

The recovery claim is now narrow: all 6,480 primary serialized payloads recovered under saved-token exact-copy replay, but visible-text retokenization and common transformations were fragile. Automated measures are not described as human ratings; no participant study or deployment was performed. The manuscript discloses unavailable cells, singular fits, post-outcome analyses, missing local GGUF files, incomplete perturbation coverage, and timing-scope limits.

The submission includes four main figures, two main tables, detailed Supplementary Information, local vector figures with provenance checks, and citation and revision audits. Data and code availability identifies the repository and exact commit. A DOI-bearing archive remains an author action if required; none has been invented here.

We believe the revision preserves RankCloak's methodological contribution while giving the adverse recoverability and detectability evidence the prominence it warrants. Thank you for considering the revised manuscript.

Sincerely,

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